

SOCIAL IMPACTS OF COMPUTING WORKSHOP 2026



SEPTEMBER 17-18
LOOKOUT ROOM
STUDENT UNION BUILDING
BOISE STATE UNIVERSITY

This two-day SioC workshop will bring together students, faculty, researchers, community members, educators, and industry partners to exchange ideas, address real-world challenges, and build new partnerships around responsible and creative uses of AI and computing technologies.

The workshop will feature keynote speaker Dr. Jay Yang, Director of the Institute for Informatics and Applied Technology at Gonzaga University, cross-sector conversations, and four focused theme sessions. Each session will run for approximately two to three hours and will include:

- Theme/session overview — an introduction to the session.
- Panel conversation — two or three speakers offering different perspectives.
- Roundtable discussion — audience-led small-group conversations.



Keynote Title: “Beyond the
Prototype: Why AI Research Needs
More Than Engineers at the Table”
-Dr. Jay Yang



BOISE STATE UNIVERSITY

SESSIONS

AI Hesitance - 9/17/26

This session examines hesitance toward AI adoption, including concerns related to trust, privacy, bias, reliability, job displacement, training, ethics, and access. Participants will discuss why people or organizations may hesitate to use AI and how responsible design and support can address these concerns.

AI Across Education - 9/17/26

This session explores AI as a catalyst for research, creative activity, teaching, and learning across educational settings. Participants will consider how AI can support innovation while also raising important questions about academic integrity, equity, learning design, assessment, and support for students and educators.

RISE + AI Scholarship - 9/18/26

This session will feature graduate researchers from Boise State's NSF-funded Responsible Innovation and Scholarship Experience program (RISE) project, along with ethicists doing work on stakeholder engagement for responsible AI design and development. Participants will explore how to mitigate AI-related risks and incorporate human flourishing throughout innovation.

Tech Kitchen - 9/18/26

This session invites participants to bring real-world challenges that could potentially be addressed through AI or computing technologies. The focus will be on connecting problems with creative ideas, practical tools, and potential partnerships.

Who Should Attend?

The SioC Workshop welcomes undergraduate and graduate students, faculty, researchers, educators, community partners, industry professionals, AI users and developers, and anyone interested in responsible, creative, and practical uses of AI and computing technologies.

Why Participate?

Participants will have the opportunity to learn about emerging AI issues, share real-world challenges, connect across sectors, contribute to collaborative problem solving, and help shape future partnerships around responsible AI innovation.



boi.st/sioc-workshop-2026

School of Computing
School for the Digital Future
SioC

**Join us to exchange ideas,
build partnerships, and
contribute to more
responsible, inclusive, and
impactful AI and computing
innovation.**